

Contact

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Top Skills

Amazon Web Services (AWS)

Microservices

Strategic Leadership

Richard Bessey

Hands on Engineering leadership, Senior Engineering Leader | VP of Platform Engineering | Director of Software Engineering & Head of Engineering

Walsall, England, United Kingdom

Summary

I thrive on diving deep into technical challenges and working hands-on with customers and engineers to deliver impactful solutions. My leadership style is grounded in a strong engineering foundation, and I'm passionate about cultivating a culture of innovation, craftsmanship, and continuous improvement—one that empowers engineers and enables outcome/value driven product development.

With over 15 years of experience across software engineering and engineering leadership, I've worked with teams of all sizes—from lean, focused squads to global engineering tribes of 100+ professionals. I'm good at right-sizing teams for maximum effectiveness, recognizing that in today's AI-augmented landscape, small high-caliber teams often deliver the most value. My blend of strategic vision and technical knowledge allows me to scale platforms, modernise architectures, and drive agile, cloud-native transformation in complex, regulated industries.

I remain committed to continuous learning, recently completing advanced training in LLM engineering and currently building my first multi-agent AI solutions. This growing hands-on experience with emerging technologies allows me to guide teams through AI exploration based on practical implementation rather than just theoretical concepts.

Locations: UK, Europe, and the USA

Industries: Financial Services, Retail, and Telecommunications

Roles: VP of Platform Engineering, Director of Software Engineering, and Head of Engineering

My core skillset and key experience include:

Emerging AI & LLM Engineering Skills (LangChain, Agent Architectures, Prompt Engineering)

Team Optimization for Maximum Efficiency (from lean squads to larger organizations)
Digital Transformation with Measurable Impact
Technology Modernization that Delivers Clear Business Value
Scaling and Optimisation of Engineering Teams and Systems
Strategy and Digital Agile Transformation
Emotional Intelligence, Mentoring, and Coaching
Technology Roadmaps and Modern Enterprise Architecture
Deep Technical Full Stack Experience
Microservices Architecture & Implementation (Java and Microsoft Stack)
Cloud Engineering, Architecture, and Operating Models (Azure, AWS, and GCP)
Data Strategy and Implementation
Compliance (GDPR, PCI DSS)
Technology Budgeting, Negotiation

Experience

BT Group

3 years 2 months

Head of Engineering

October 2022 - Present (2 years 7 months)

Snr Engineering Manager

March 2022 - October 2022 (8 months)

GBG Plc

Engineering Development Manager

February 2021 - March 2022 (1 year 2 months)

FLEETCOR

5 years 8 months

Vice President - UK & EU Development

October 2017 - October 2020 (3 years 1 month)

Birmingham, Walsall

Director of Software Development - epyx

July 2016 - October 2017 (1 year 4 months)

Meriden

Driving the agile transformation across IT and the business creating cross-functional teams. Setting up product focused self-sufficient teams delivering iterative change, to enable the business to meet its revenue target. Using continual improvement metrics to create a positive and fun goal orientated environment.

Implementing Devops pipeline using TFS, Octopus, MS test, JMeter and Selenium to increase change cadence while focusing on increasing quality.

Working as part of the cross function team to manage the successful application migration to new data center.

Director, Data Migration

March 2015 - June 2016 (1 year 4 months)

Managing multiple parallel migration projects, with a blend of onshore FTE leads and offshore resources. Working closely with the team to re-evaluate existing processes, and focus on business objectives.

Transform the migration process to enable scaling of teams, improving planning process, introduction of TFS and change control process, increasing transparency and the impact of change on other teams and collaboration with stakeholders. Coaching teams to be independent and drive migration events.

Bet365

Software Development Team Leader

April 2014 - March 2015 (1 year)

Managing .Net developers, enhancing existing In-Play and Pre-game trading applications and models. Leading the delivery of a number of concurrent projects to time scale and budget in an energetic fast pace a diverse environment, where results are rewarded.

Implementing SDLC changes, continually looking at the way we develop and deliver effectively. Working with new and existing clients to consume data feeds, designing distributed multi-tiered applications, with SQL and message orientated design (ZeroMQ and RabbitMQ).

FLEETCOR

Development Team Lead

March 2012 - March 2014 (2 years 1 month)

walsall, united kingdom

Hands on leadership of a team of developers of varying experiences, and managing contractors in and out of projects. Working with teams in head office in Atlanta both in person and via remote working. Liaising with international clients to understand requirements and agree program of work. Monitoring sprints and personal performance against plan, and taking corrective action where need. Following up with staff to ensure lessons learnt and encouraging proactive behaviours.

Using Microsoft technologies in a multi-tiered enterprise solution with ASP.net JQuery UI and C# over a federated database leveraging SQL Server replication to prevent process heavy jobs effecting customer experience, and using multi-threading to optimise performance and deliver a scalable product.

Working with stakeholders to drive out functional requirements and user stories. Producing lightweight documents which support the agile development life cycle.

Education

Aberystwyth University

Bsc, Freshwater and Marine Biology

University of Wales, Aberystwyth

MSc, Computer Science